Chapter 1: Starting a Small Garden

A small garden can begin with a single window box. Choose a spot that gets at least four hours of sunlight each day, and fill your container with good quality soil.

Herbs such as basil, mint and parsley are forgiving for beginners. They grow quickly, and you can start using them in your cooking within a few weeks.

Water your plants in the early morning so the soil stays moist through the day. Check the soil with your finger, and water only when the top layer feels dry.

Chapter 2: Caring for Your Plants

Every plant needs light, water and food. Feed your garden with compost or a gentle liquid fertiliser every two to three weeks during the growing season.

Remove yellow leaves as soon as you see them. This helps the plant send its energy to healthy growth, and it keeps pests away.

If you see small insects on the leaves, wash them off with a gentle spray of water. Repeat this every few days until the leaves stay clean.

Chapter 3: Harvesting and Sharing

Harvest in the morning, when the leaves are full of moisture. Use clean scissors and cut just above a pair of leaves so the plant can grow back.

Share your harvest with neighbours and friends. A small bunch of fresh herbs is a lovely gift, and it often starts a good conversation about gardening.